



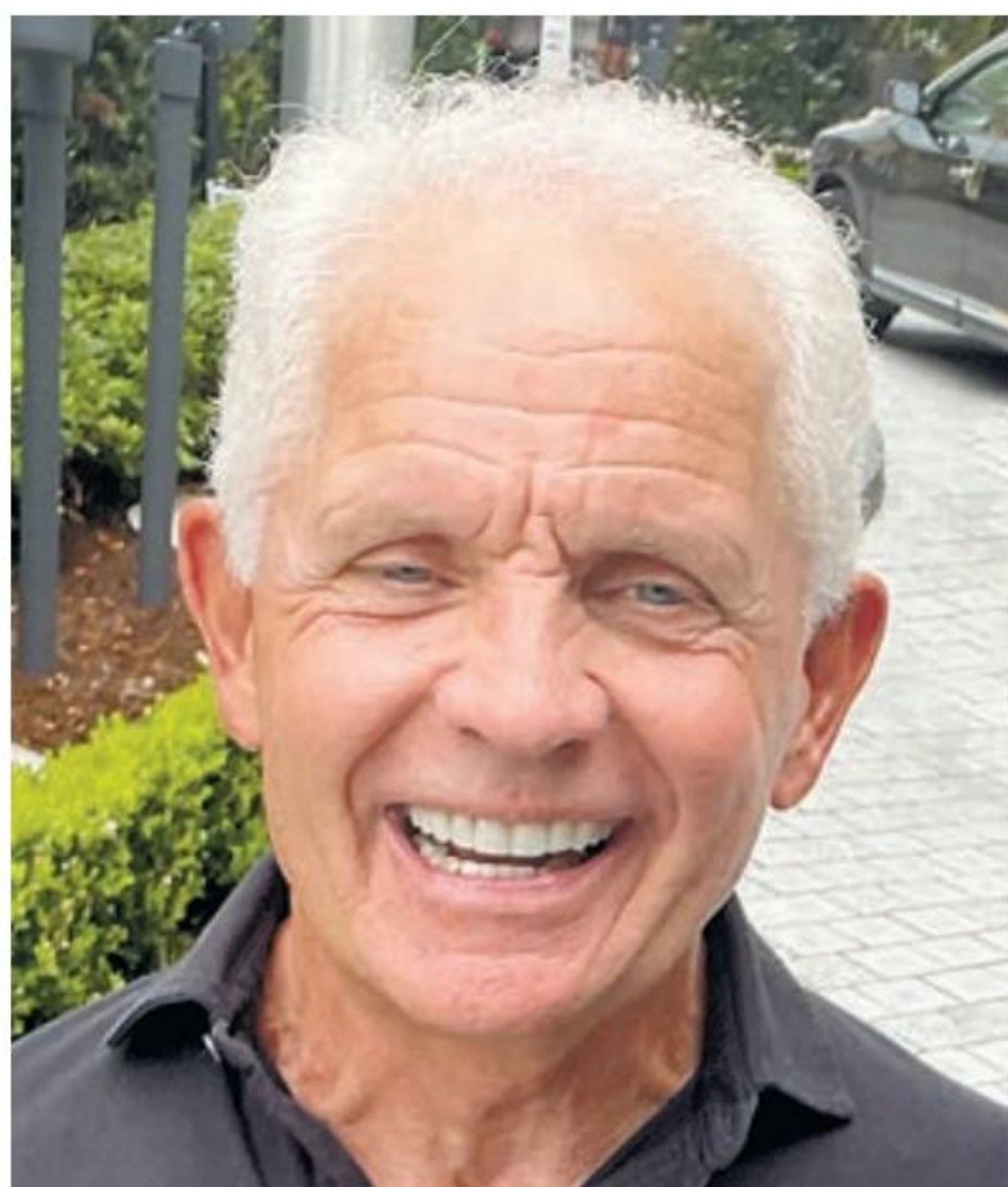
» VANTAGE POINT

Pics: GETTY IMAGES

What's the ideal physique in tennis?

Sports performance expert Mackie Shilstone discusses the **physiology of tennis athletes** in an in-depth conversation with Paul Fein.

SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Paul Fein

Superb physiques have long been the hallmark of tennis champions. Harry Hopman, the legendary Davis Cup captain, made superior fitness the cornerstone of the Australian men's dynasty in the 1950s and '60s. As a teenager in the late 1950s, Margaret Court (**above**) — the trailblazer for rigorous training in women's tennis — became the first woman to use weights. Dozens of double-knee jumps every day,

jumping rope, and two-hundred-yard wind sprints also made the Australian superstar the best-conditioned and strongest player of her era.

Bjorn Borg, the lean Swedish speedster who reigned in the 1970s, once told arch-rival John McEnroe he never got tired in a tournament match. Martina Navratilova turned into a muscular, super-fit 'bionic woman', as the media labelled her, and became almost unbeatable for much of the 1980s, while another Czech-turned-American star and